

Football Club On eBay!

Dinel Staicu, owner of Romanian second division side Universitatea Craiova, tried to give the club to his local council. The council said they weren't interested. Staicu then said, "The only thing I can think of doing now is putting it on eBay and seeing if I can find someone to take it over."



Linux Leader Quits

Richard Seibt, one of the leading lights behind SuSE Linux before it was acquired by Novell, has quit. Seibt's resignation comes just a week after Novell made Ron Hovsepian president of worldwide field operations. Hovsepian and Seibt had been public about their differing opinions about SuSE's future.



Escape

WHAT SAY BABY?

Scientists Working On Baby Babble Translator

The cryptic cries, grins and gurgles of babies that leave parents dumbfounded could soon be deciphered, if modern technology delivers as it promises.

Three years after a toymaker scored a smash hit with the 'Bowlingual' gadget to interpret the warp and woof of a dog's life, Japanese researchers may have an even bigger sensation—a translator for baby babbling.

"We aim to develop a device to read babies' feelings," says Kazuyuki Shinohara, a neurobiology professor at the state-run Nagasaki University who leads the research team.

Shinohara's group has been conducting experiments involving mothers and their babies by monitoring the infants'

cries, facial expressions and body temperature changes in a project backed by the government-subsidised Japan Science and Technology Agency.

"We are trying to read babies' faces numerically such as the distance between eyebrows and the nose tip," said Shinohara. As for other clues on what

babies mean to say, researchers are analysing whether high or low frequencies in the sound of the cries show they want specific things.

The team is also monitoring temperatures of the babies' bodies, mostly the face, using thermography. Shinohara says the changes in temperature indicate particular desires.

The professor, who declined to elaborate on his conclusions or the shape of the gadget pending patenting, aims to launch the device by mid-2006.

The product would be for use at medical institutions and homes. The professor would like to price a home-use version below ₹10,000 (approx. Rs 4,100).

"You may lose confidence as a parent if your baby cries a lot. But your child-rearing ability increases by trial and error," says Yuko Iguchi, clinical psychologist at National Children's Castle in Tokyo. Shinohara claims his device

could make bringing up children more enjoyable for parents. "It is cruel just to tell them 'You should naturally know what your baby wants'," he says. "There is no use scolding parents. We want them to have fun raising babies by taking advantage of tech."



Illustrations: Harsho Mohan Chatteraj

UNUSABLE!

<http://tamilnaduinfotech.com>



"Tamilnadu Infotech THE WEB COMPANY"

That's it.

Huh? Well, that's it!

Don't get it? OK, let's explain a little bit: that piece of information—that Tamilnadu Infotech is "The Web Company"—is all there is on <http://tamilnaduinfotech.com>. It's a .jpeg logo.

We tried clicking on the logo, then, in frustration, on random places all over the page—to no avail. Then we realised that we could view the page source, and there it was—one jpeg logo, that's all.

We'd assume that the site is under construction, but wouldn't an 'under construction' logo or text have helped? Without that, we're forced to conclude that Tamilnadu Infotech doesn't have anything to tell the world except that it is "The Web Company".

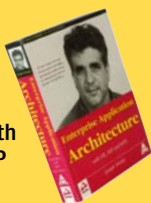
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My Desktop

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The winner receives a copy of **Enterprise Application Architecture With VB, MTS and ASP**

By Joseph Moniz, published by Shroff Publishers & Distributors Pvt. Ltd. This month's winner is **Shubhajit Maity**



Shubhajit's desktop makes good use of desktop tweaking tools, cursor enhancements and player skins. We love the icons and taskbar transparency. Congrats Shubhajit!